WEEK 09 • IS321 ENTERPRISE ARCHITECTURE

Linking Strategy, Business, and Technology

How EA Makes Sure Technology Serves the Business — Not the Other Way Around

TODAY'S ROADMAP

What We'll Cover

01	**Why Linking Matters**	EA is most effective when it drives both top-down and bottom-up planning at once
02	**Linking EA and Strategy**	Documenting goals, initiatives, and measures so strategy shapes everything downstream
03	**Linking EA and Business Planning**	What EA documents at the business level, and why
04	**Linking EA and Technology Planning**	A preview — why technology should follow strategy, not lead it
05	**Worked Example**	Tracing one strategic goal through business and technology

Why Linking Matters

> *For EA to support an enterprise holistically, it must link strategy, business, and technology — so that strategy drives business and technology planning, not the other way around.*

— The core argument for linking strategy, business, and technology

EA is most effective when it does both at once

Top-Down

Executive planning and decision-making across the whole enterprise.

Bottom-Up

Management planning and decision-making within each individual Line of Business.

Especially Critical When...

Working across multiple organizations to build common resources (e.g. supply chains), or merging/acquiring organizations into one enterprise.

LINK 1 OF 2 (IN DEPTH)

Linking EA and Strategy



The EA framework and methodology organizes documentation so strategy can influence business and technology planning — especially important when documenting future EA views. By identifying anticipated changes in strategic goals first, everything documented afterward can align with where the enterprise is actually headed.

Documenting strategy means identifying three things: goals, initiatives, and outcome measures — covered individually on the next slide.

KPI

DOCUMENTING STRATEGY

Three Elements of Strategy

Strategic Goals

The enterprise's primary objectives, typically taking several years to accomplish. They change in response to internal/external business and technology drivers, or changes in laws and regulations.

Strategic Initiatives

The business and technology activities, programs, and projects that enable strategic goals — significant enough to affect the enterprise's fundamental direction.

Strategic Measures

The outcome measures that identify when an initiative has successfully met a goal — how the enterprise knows it's accomplishing its mission, when it "wins."

LINK 2 OF 2 (IN DEPTH)

Linking EA and Business Planning



As reflected in the EA framework's design: strategy creates business requirements, and technology supports solutions for meeting those requirements. EA documents three primary issues at the business level — covered on the next slide.

At the Business Level

EA documents 3 issues at bus level

which activities support strategic goals



1 → strategy-driven
→ general support

Supporting Strategic Goals

bridge between initiatives & business activities should be addressed

Touch points between strategic initiatives and business activities must be clearly documented. Not all business activities are strategic — EA distinguishes those directly linked to initiatives from general support functions.

business activities can be classified as general support function OR tailored activities directly supporting initiatives



2

Documentation of Business Activities → how they developed and delivered

Documenting how business products/services are created and delivered supports BPI and BPR projects — showing inputs, outputs, outcomes, and how processes link to one another.



3

Identifying Supporting Technologies

Analyzing business requirements reveals critical supporting technologies — e.g. marketing needs sales-trend data; manufacturing needs materials, facilities, labor, computers, and/or robotics.

LINK 3 OF 3 (PREVIEWED HERE, DETAILED NEXT WEEK)

Linking EA and Technology Planning



Technology is a resource that enables information and other resource flows — supporting the creation and delivery of business products and services, which in turn achieves strategic goals.

The Warning

Technology should not drive business and strategy planning — especially in resource-constrained enterprises that can't afford duplicative, non-strategic technologies. Bottom-up planning (technology as the catalyst for change) is a valid use of EA but it's not the normal process. The enterprise should understand its priorities first, plan business activities, and only then identify supporting resources — including IT.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Tracing a Goal Through Strategy, Business, and Technology

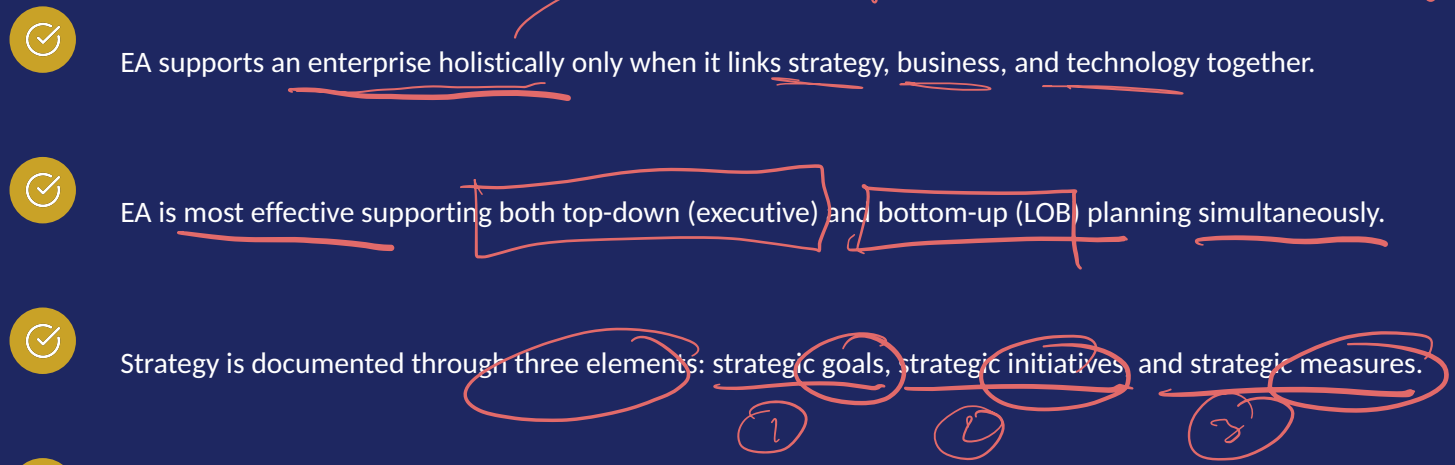
Back to Amanah Bank's open-banking goal (Week 3) — this time tracing it through the strategy → business → technology chain instead of the five EA levels.

adopt a Top-Bottom Approach



CHAPTER SUMMARY

Key Takeaways



- EA supports an enterprise holistically only when it links strategy, business, and technology together.
- EA is most effective supporting both top-down (executive) and bottom-up (LOB) planning simultaneously.
- Strategy is documented through three elements: strategic goals, strategic initiatives, and strategic measures.
- At the business level, EA documents which activities support strategic goals, how business activities work, and what supporting technologies they require.
- The ordering principle is non-negotiable: strategy drives business, business drives technology — not the reverse.

normal process

COMING UP NEXT

Further Reading & Next Session

Reading Material

- Bernard, S. (2012). An Introduction to Enterprise Architecture (3rd ed.), Chapter 3 — Primary text
- Shelly, G. B., & Rosenblatt, H. J. (2011). Systems Analysis and Design (9th ed.)
- Week 3's Amanah Bank example (extended in this chapter's worked example)

Next: Week 10

Linking EA and Technology Planning in full — web services, SaaS, SOA, virtualization, and grid computing — plus Intelligent Enterprise Systems. Mapped to CLO3, CLO5.

Questions?